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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

Starting off with psychology as a basis for the extended essay made it very difficult to investigate the artistic nature I wanted to. I decided to switch to art and was able to settle in much easier and find a topic as well as questions quite quickly. After experimenting with materials in the art class, I decided to research the use of unconventional materials, as well as what material can communicate specifically within the works of three female artists who came from a similar time. I did research on each artist individually using interviews, videos, and some articles.

One example of transfer of learning that influenced my approach was when I applied the systematic research methods I learned in my psychology studies to my art research. In psychology, I had learned to collect and analyze data meticulously, looking for patterns and themes. I transferred these skills to my art research, which helped me methodically dissect each artwork to understand how the artists' use of unconventional materials communicated specific ideas or emotions.

I got to the point where I had analyzed all the artworks of the three artists I had chosen, broken down the pieces into their formal qualities, as well as focused on the use of unconventional materials. It was also very important that I understood the history of this time and if the use of these unconventional/peculiar materials was influenced by the time period in which all three artists grew up in—the time period also helped me understand how these artists influenced the people around them.

I am quite pleased with how my essay turned out. Despite there being space for improvement, skills-wise, I did well on sourcing and gathering information as well as referencing it throughout my essay. There was a lot of information on my topic and my artists, and I tried to use a lot of what I found. However, upon reflecting, I feel that I may have used too much. I analyzed and interpreted the artists and their artworks carefully and efficiently, which helped me acquire a deep understanding of my artists and their pieces. A majority of my research came from personal writings, diary entries, or conversations from both artists in the form of books. To me, this was the best way I could have gathered research because I was able to learn about my artists on a more personal level as well as learn a bit of the thought process behind their works.

While I do feel I could have organized my research before I began writing much better, so I could separate what I really needed and didn't (in order to prevent cramming information), I think I learned a lot about my topic, how art has changed and evolved during the time, how the artist I chose influenced art today... but most importantly, I feel as though I was able to answer and support my question while showing a range of the information I acquired since the beginning of my EE.

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